Community Emergency Drill Arrangements

This document sets out the arrangements for the upcoming community emergency drill, a simulated exercise designed to test local response coordination. It covers purpose, participating roles, scheduling, safety protocols, evaluation methods, and record-keeping duties. The drill is not a real emergency activation; all observations are simulated and any performance indicators are for internal learning only. No causal claims about actual incident outcomes are made. The arrangements apply to all volunteers, observers, and partner agencies involved in the exercise.

A Drill Purpose and Scope

The drill aims to practise evacuation, communication, and resource allocation under simulated pressure. Scope is limited to the designated community zones and excludes real emergency dispatch. Participating households receive advance notice, and all activities remain within the exercise boundary. The exercise does not test real response times as causal measures; instead, it records simulated observations for after-action review. The scope also defines which agencies may observe and which may actively participate.

A.1 Planning and Coordination

A planning committee coordinates logistics, volunteer assignments, and safety briefings. The committee meets regularly during the preparation period and maintains a shared checklist. Coordination includes confirming venue permissions, first-aid coverage, and communication channels. All planning decisions are documented and shared with participants in advance. The committee also prepares contingency plans for weather or other disruptions, ensuring the drill remains safe and within the simulated scope.

A.1.1 Roles and Responsibilities

Clear role assignment is essential for a safe and orderly drill. The following subsections define the duties of controllers, safety officers, and evaluators. Each role has specific authorities and limits, and all role holders receive a briefing before the exercise begins. Role holders must not exceed their simulated authority or interfere with real emergency services. The table below summarises the main duty categories and reporting lines.

Supporting records are presented in Figure 1.



Figure 1: Role categories and main responsibilities

A.1.1.1 Controller Duties and Communication

Controllers manage the exercise flow, issue simulated injects, and maintain radio discipline. They must log every inject and response observation using the provided forms. Controllers do not direct real emergency resources and must clearly label all messages as exercise traffic. They report to the chief controller and coordinate with safety officers before any scenario escalation. Controllers also ensure that participants understand the difference between simulated and real instructions.

Supporting records are presented in Table 1.

Duty	Description	Reports to	Limit
Inject control	Issue simulated events	Chief controller	No real resources
Radio discipline	Enforce phrasing	Chief controller	Exercise only
Log keeping	Record actions	Chief controller	Timestamped
Escalation	Coordinate with safety	Safety officer	Safety overrides

Table 1: Controller duties and reporting lines

A.1.1.2 Safety Officer Authority

Safety officers have absolute authority to pause or stop the drill if they observe a real hazard. They conduct pre-drill safety checks, monitor participant welfare, and maintain contact with on-site first aid. Safety officers wear distinctive identification and are briefed on all simulated hazards. Their stop authority overrides controller instructions. Any safety intervention is recorded and reviewed after the exercise to improve future arrangements.

Supporting records are presented in Table 2.

Check	Responsibility	Timing	Action if failed
Exits clear	Safety officer	Before start	Pause drill
First aid ready	Safety officer	Before start	Pause drill
Hazards marked	Safety officer	Before start	Remediate
Welfare check	Safety officer	During drill	Stop drill

Table 2: Safety officer pre-drill checks and stop authority

A.1.2 Evaluator Observation Methods

Evaluators use structured observation forms to record simulated actions, communication clarity, and adherence to procedures. They do not intervene in the exercise except through safety channels. Observations are timestamped and cross-checked with controller logs. Evaluators focus on learning points rather than pass or fail judgments. Their notes feed into the after-action review and help identify training needs. The table below outlines the observation criteria used by evaluators.

Supporting records are presented in Table 3.

Criterion	Focus	Method	Record
Communication	Clarity	Direct observation	Timestamped note
Procedure	Adherence	Checklist	Yes or no
Safety	Awareness	Observation	Narrative
Coordination	Teamwork	Cross-check	Log comparison

Table 3: Evaluator observation criteria and focus areas

A.2 Participant Briefing and Consent

All participants attend a briefing that explains the exercise objectives, safety rules, and the voluntary nature of involvement. Consent forms are collected before the drill, and participants may withdraw at any time without penalty. The briefing clarifies that no real emergency services will be dispatched and that all communications are simulated. Participants receive written materials in accessible formats. The table below lists the key briefing topics and confirmation steps.

Supporting records are presented in Table 4.

Topic	Content	Confirmation	Responsible
Objectives	Purpose and scope	Sign-off	Briefing lead
Safety rules	Stop authority	Verbal check	Safety officer
Communication	Exercise phrase	Practice	Controller
Consent	Voluntary nature	Form collected	Admin

Table 4: Participant briefing topics and confirmation steps

B Schedule and Logistics

The drill schedule is designed to minimise disruption to community routines while allowing sufficient time for setup and debrief. Logistics cover venue preparation, equipment distribution, and refreshment arrangements. The schedule includes buffer periods for safety checks and unexpected delays. All timing is communicated through multiple channels. The subsections below detail the phased timeline and the resource allocation plan.

B.1 Phased Drill Timeline

The timeline is divided into preparation, execution, and debrief phases. Preparation includes site setup and final safety checks. Execution follows a scripted sequence of simulated events. Debrief occurs immediately after the exercise to capture initial observations. Each phase has designated leads and checkpoints. The table below presents the phase schedule with responsible parties and key activities.

B.1.1 Resource Allocation Plan

Resources include volunteers, communication equipment, first-aid supplies, and printed materials. Allocation is based on zone needs and simulated scenario requirements. A central cache manages equipment check-in and check-out. Resource shortfalls are logged for future planning. The plan ensures that no zone is over-resourced at the expense of another. The subsections below describe equipment staging and volunteer assignment.

B.1.1.1 Equipment Staging and Checkout

Equipment is staged at the command post and distributed to zone leaders before the drill starts. Checkout logs record item, quantity, and responsible person. Radios are tested on designated channels, and spare batteries are available. After the drill, all equipment is returned and inspected. Damaged or missing items are reported to the logistics lead. Staging follows a simple layout that keeps walkways clear and access unobstructed.

B.1.1.2 Volunteer Assignment and Rotation

Volunteers are assigned to zones based on training and availability. Rotation schedules

prevent fatigue during the exercise. Each volunteer receives a role card and knows their reporting point. Relief volunteers are on standby for unexpected absences. Assignment adjustments are made through the zone leader and logged at the command post. Volunteers are reminded that their participation is simulated and that they may raise safety concerns at any time.

B.1.2 Communication Channels and Protocols

Communication protocols define primary and backup channels for exercise traffic. All messages begin and end with the phrase exercise, exercise to prevent confusion with real incidents. Radio discipline is enforced, and sensitive information is not transmitted. The table below summarises the communication channels and their designated uses.

Supporting records are presented in Table 5.

Channel	Primary use	Backup	Notes
Radio A	Command traffic	Radio B	Exercise phrase
Radio B	Zone coordination	Radio A	Monitor at all times
Phone tree	Safety alerts	Radio A	Test before drill
Notice board	Public updates	Phone tree	Accessible format

Table 5: Communication channels and designated uses

B.2 Post-Drill Review and Reporting

After the drill, the planning committee compiles observations, safety reports, and participant feedback into an after-action report. The report distinguishes simulated observations from any real-world claims and avoids causal conclusions. Findings are shared with participants and partner agencies. Recommendations are tracked for implementation. The review process emphasises learning, transparency, and continuous improvement of future drill arrangements.